



(Don't Write anything in this Area)

5.b) Big Man based society and Chiefdom

Big Man based society, it is a political institution in which Big Man or chief holds power and authority. It is found in Melanesian society.

Chiefdom: It is also a political institution resting with an individual (chief).

However difference,

Big Man based society	Chiefdom.
1) Political system much more <u>informal</u> . 2) Not hereditary. 3) Part of <u>stateless</u> political organisation. 4) Big Man mostly in society with subsistence economic activity.	1) <u>Formal</u> institution. 2) Hereditary. 3) Part of <u>stateless</u> as well as state. It is <u>intermediary</u> between both. 4) Subsistence & non-subsistence both.

5) Less Authority than chief.

6) Diffused power

NEW: Leopard skin chief

5) More Authority

6) More concentrated power

Laopula, Zambia

give Examples

Similarities

- 1) Both hold consensus.
- 2) Adjudication function.
- 3) Both help in social control.
- 4) Both feature of simple societies

Include service - Managerial benefit theory

Thus studying both will help in knowing the transition from states to state political societies.

Sahlins - internal regulation principle.

concept was given by Marshall Sahlins in 'Poor Man, Rich man, Big man: Political types in Melanesia' poly version

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